Protecting the Breathing System

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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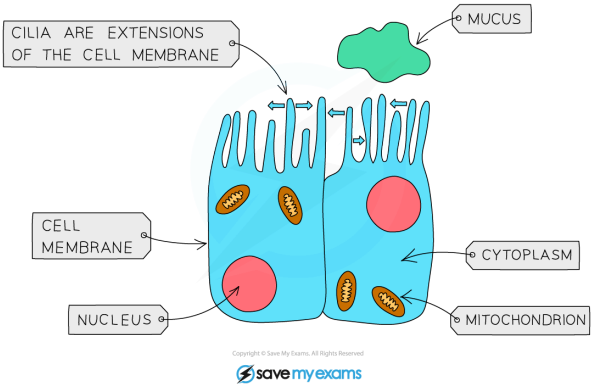
Protecting the Breathing System: Extended

Extended Tier Only

- The passages down to the lungs are lined with **ciliated epithelial cells**
- Cilia comes from the Latin for eyelash, so unsurprisingly these cells have tiny **hairs** on the end of them that **beat** and **push mucus up the passages towards the nose and throat** where it can be removed
- The **mucus** is made by special mucus-producing cells called **goblet cells** because they are shaped like a goblet, or cup
- The mucus traps **particles, pathogens like bacteria or viruses, and dust** and **prevents them getting into the lungs** and damaging the cells there



Mucus traps particles, dust and pathogens and cilia beat and push it up and away from the lungs

Help me understand

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

Examiner Tips and Tricks

1. The mucus is produced by goblet cells and **traps bacteria, dust, particles**
2. The cilia **beat**
3. And **push the mucus away from the lungs towards the throat**

This is quite simple, but often marks are lost as students haven't been **precise** enough with their explanations!

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